

Biology All In One (BAIO) Learning System

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Chapter 9: Biotechnology – Principles and Processes

Worksheet · Selectable Markers & Insertional Inactivation

I. Multiple Choice Questions

- Genes that help distinguish recombinants from non-recombinants are called:
(A) Structural genes (B) Selectable markers
(C) Housekeeping genes (D) Promoter genes
- Disruption of a gene's function due to insertion of foreign DNA within it is called:
(A) Transformation (B) Insertional inactivation
(C) Transduction (D) Conjugation
- Besides antibiotic resistance genes, which gene can serve as an alternate selectable marker?
(A) β -galactosidase gene (B) Haemoglobin gene
(C) Insulin gene (D) Actin gene
- amp^R confers resistance to which antibiotic?
(A) Tetracycline (B) Ampicillin
(C) Streptomycin (D) Penicillin G only
- tet^R confers resistance to which antibiotic?
(A) Ampicillin (B) Tetracycline
(C) Kanamycin (D) Chloramphenicol

II. Fill in the Blanks

- Disruption of a gene's function due to insertion of foreign DNA within it is called _____.
- In pBR322, the BamHI recognition site lies within the _____ gene.
- Besides antibiotic resistance, the _____ gene can serve as an alternate selectable marker.
- On a chromogenic substrate, non-recombinant colonies (active enzyme) appear _____ in colour.
- Recombinant colonies with an inactivated marker gene appear _____ on a chromogenic substrate.
- Recombinants with a disrupted tet^R gene grow on _____ medium but not on tetracycline medium.

III. Match the Following

Column A	Column B
1. Blue colony	a. Ampicillin resistance gene
2. Colourless colony	b. Recombinant on chromogenic substrate
3. amp^R	c. Loss of gene function from DNA insertion
4. Insertional inactivation	d. Non-recombinant on chromogenic substrate

IV. True / False

- Blue colonies on a chromogenic substrate represent successful recombinants. [True / False]

2. Insertional inactivation destroys a gene's original function. [True / False]
3. Non-recombinants lose antibiotic resistance after transformation. [True / False]
4. Recombinants (BamHI insertion in tetR) grow on ampicillin but die on tetracycline. [True / False]
5. Chromogenic substrates help visually distinguish recombinants from non-recombinants. [True / False]

V. 2 Marks Questions

1. Explain how antibiotic resistance genes help distinguish recombinants from non-recombinants.

2. Describe the principle of blue-white screening using the β -galactosidase gene.

VI. 3 Marks Questions

1. Why do non-recombinant colonies grow on both ampicillin and tetracycline media?

2. What is insertional inactivation, and where else besides antibiotic genes can it be applied?

VII. 5 Marks Questions

1. With the help of a diagram, explain how antibiotic resistance genes (ampR and tetR) are used to distinguish recombinant bacteria from non-recombinant bacteria through insertional inactivation.
